

Storage Guidelines

1. Overview

These guidelines help you store the vehicle and its components safely for short-term or long-term periods. Proper storage protects the battery, tyres, fluids, and electronic systems from unnecessary wear and ensures the vehicle is ready to use when needed.

2. Preparing the Vehicle for Storage

Clean and Inspect

Give the vehicle a thorough wash, including the underbody. Dirt, salt, and moisture left on the surface can cause corrosion over time. Check for fluid leaks, loose trim pieces, or exposed wiring before parking it for an extended period.

Fluids

- Make sure the engine oil, coolant, and brake fluid are at correct levels.
- If the next service is close, it's better to complete it before storage.
- A fresh oil change prevents contaminants from sitting inside the engine.

Battery

- Either disconnect the negative terminal or connect a maintenance charger.
- Avoid leaving the battery connected on a vehicle that won't run for weeks.
- Keep the battery in a cool, dry spot if removed from the vehicle.

Fuel

- For petrol engines, fill the tank to reduce moisture buildup.
 - Add a fuel stabiliser to prevent degradation during long storage.
 - For diesel engines, avoid storing the vehicle with very low fuel to prevent condensation.
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3. Tyres and Suspension

Tyre Pressure

- Inflate tyres slightly above the standard recommended pressure.
- This prevents flat spots when the vehicle stays still for long periods.

Avoiding Suspension Stress

- If storage is longer than a few months, move the vehicle slightly every few weeks to relieve load on the same tyre patch.
 - On very long-term storage, consider using axle stands to reduce suspension compression.
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4. Environmental Conditions

Indoors

The ideal storage space is covered, dry, and well ventilated. This protects the vehicle from UV damage, moisture, and sudden temperature changes.

Outdoors

If indoor space isn't available:

- Use a breathable, weather-resistant cover.
- Avoid fully waterproof covers that trap moisture.
- Park on a solid surface rather than soil or grass to reduce humidity exposure.

Temperature

- Moderately cool temperatures are best.
 - Extreme heat accelerates battery drain and fluid breakdown.
 - Extreme cold slows chemical processes and can thicken fluids.
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5. Interior Care

Ventilation

Leave windows slightly cracked if stored indoors to prevent musty smells. Do not do this outdoors due to insects, dust, or rain.

Moisture Control

Use a small moisture absorber inside the cabin to prevent mould, especially in humid areas.

Upholstery

- Clean seats and carpets before storage.

- Avoid leaving food, water bottles, or damp items inside the vehicle.
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6. Periodic Checks During Storage

Even when the vehicle isn't in use, it's good to check it every few weeks:

- Start the engine briefly to circulate oil, but avoid repeated short idling sessions if you can't drive it.
 - Roll the vehicle a little to avoid flat spotting tyres.
 - Verify the battery isn't losing charge excessively.
 - Inspect for rodents, insects, or signs of nesting around wiring or insulation.
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7. Returning the Vehicle to Use

Before driving again:

- Check tyre pressures and adjust to normal levels.
- Confirm all fluids are correct and there are no leaks.
- Reconnect the battery if it was removed.
- Start the engine and let it idle for a minute while observing warning lights.
- Test lights, indicators, brakes, and infotainment systems.

If the vehicle was stored for several months, a quick service check is a good idea.